

ULTHWÉ STRIKE FORCE

THE BLACK GUARDIANS AT THE EYE

AELDARI • ASURYANI • ULTHWÉ

“We of Ulthwé do not walk the Paths. We stand the Watch. The Eye is at our door — let it never find us looking away.” — Farseer Eldrad Ulthran. Ulthwé alone of the Craftworlds maintains a true standing army — the Black Guardians, robed in funereal cloth and bearing arms day and night against the moment when the Eye of Terror disgorges its next horror. Where other Craftworlders' arms-skill rusts between crises, Ulthwé's never does.

FACTION ABILITY — BATTLE FOCUS

Uses the canonical Aeldari faction ability **Battle Focus** from Codex: Aeldari (10e). If an **AELDARI** unit from your army Advanced this turn, its ranged weapons gain the [ASSAULT] ability for the turn (where they did not have it already).

DETACHMENT RULE — STANDING ARMY

Standing Army

Ulthwé's Guardians are not citizen-militia called to brief service. They are sworn-from-birth defenders, drilled across decades. Their fire is one pip truer; their blades, one cut surer.

While a friendly **Guardian Defenders** unit is part of this Detachment, models in that unit improve the Ballistic Skill (BS) of their ranged weapons by 1 (a BS 4+ weapon becomes BS 3+; a BS 3+ weapon remains BS 3+ — this rule cannot improve BS below 3+).

While a friendly **Storm Guardians** unit is part of this Detachment, models in that unit improve their melee Weapon Skill (WS) by 1 in the same fashion (a WS 4+ becomes WS 3+; floor at WS 3+).

These units may, for narrative or marshalling purposes, be referred to as **Black Guardian Defenders** and **Black Guardian Storm Squads** respectively. Reflects the 3rd Ed *Eye of Terror Campaign Codex*'s Ulthwé Strike Force profiles (BS 4 / WS 4 vs the era's standard Guardian BS 3 / WS 3).

DETACHMENT COMPOSITION

✓ **Included:** All canonical **Aeldari (Asuryani)** units. Detachment particularly favours **Guardian Defenders**, **Storm Guardians**, **Farseers**, **Warlock Conclaves**, and other Ulthwé-associated profiles.

✗ **Excluded:** **Drukhari**, **Harlequins**, **Ynnari**, and **Corsair** warband detachments — Ulthwé is Asuryani-only.

✓ **Required:** At least one **Farseer** (or Farseer Skyrunner) and at least one **Guardian Defenders** or **Storm Guardians** unit must be in your army to use this Detachment. The Strike Force collapses without its Seer-and-Standing-Watch core.

ENHANCEMENTS

Witchblade of the Damned 30 pts

An ancient witchblade carried by the Farseers of Ulthwé in their long watch over the Eye. Wounds it inflicts do not merely cut — they sever the foe's connection to the warp.

Bearer's Witchblade gains the [DEVASTATING WOUNDS] ability, and improves its Damage from D3 to D3+1. Additionally, once per battle, the bearer may automatically cast the *Doom* Psychic Power (selecting a target normally) without taking a Psychic test. (*Farseer or Farseer Skyrunner only.*)

Crystal Targeting Matrix 20 pts

A crystal lattice bonded to the bearer's psy-system, feeding firing solutions into the minds of every Ulthwé warrior within range.

While the bearer is leading a unit, ranged weapons equipped by models in that unit gain the **[SUSTAINED HITS 1]** ability. If the bearer's unit is a **Guardian Defenders** unit, that unit additionally gains **[LETHAL HITS]** on Critical Hits of 6. *(Aeldari Character only.)*

Black Robes of Ulthwé 15 pts

The Black Robes are not just livery — the cloth is woven through with rune-thread, an ancient ward against the warp's whispers.

Bearer's unit has a **5+ Feel No Pain** against Mortal Wounds, and ranged attacks made against the bearer's unit by **[PSYCHIC]** weapons suffer -1 to the Hit roll. *(Aeldari Character only.)*

The Eye's Vigil 25 pts

The bearer carries a heart-shard of Ulthwé's great Infinity Circuit — a constant whisper of foretelling that bleeds outward to every warrior in earshot.

Once per battle, at the start of your opponent's Command phase, you may have the bearer take a Battle-shock test on a Leadership of 5+. If it is passed, friendly **Ulthwé** units within 12" of the bearer add 1 to their Objective Control characteristic until the start of your next turn, and the bearer's unit additionally gains the **Stealth** ability for the same duration. *(Aeldari Character only.)*

STRATAGEMS

Ulthwé's Vengeance 1 CP

Ulthwé Strike Force — Battle Tactic Stratagem

Black Guardians do not waste shots. Each ribbon of shuriken-fire is a quietly precise verdict.

WHEN: Your Shooting phase, just after a friendly Ulthwé unit is selected to shoot.

TARGET: That Ulthwé unit.

EFFECT: Until the end of the phase, ranged attacks made by models in this unit have the **[SUSTAINED HITS 1]** ability and ignore the Benefit of Cover.

Eldritch Foresight 1 CP

Ulthwé Strike Force — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

The Farseer's vision parts the future like a hand parting smoke — the foe's arrows fly where no Aeldari now stands.

WHEN: Start of your opponent's Shooting phase.

TARGET: One friendly **Farseer** or **Warlock Conclave** unit.

EFFECT: Until the end of the phase, all friendly Ulthwé units within 12" of the target Psyker unit subtract 1 from enemy Hit rolls made against them.

Last Stand at the Eye 1 CP

Ulthwé Strike Force — Battle Tactic Stratagem

The Black Guardians do not yield the Watch. Their dead remain at their posts, weapons levelled.

WHEN: Start of your opponent's Shooting phase.

TARGET: One friendly Ulthwé Infantry unit that is wholly within range of an objective marker you control.

EFFECT: Until the end of the phase, the unit has a 4+ Invulnerable save against ranged attacks. The unit also automatically passes any Battle-shock test it is called on to take until the end of the turn.

Doomspeaker's Curse 2 CP

Ulthwé Strike Force — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

The Doomspeaker names the foe's fate aloud, and every shot thereafter rides the geometry of that fate.

WHEN: Your Command phase.

TARGET: One enemy unit within 24" and Line of Sight of a friendly **Farseer** in your army.

EFFECT: Until the start of your next turn, attacks made by friendly Ulthwé units against the target unit add 1 to the Wound roll. A unit can be the target of this Stratagem only once per battle.

The Standing Watch 1 CP

Ulthwé Strike Force — Battle Tactic Stratagem

The Watch endures. The Watch is the Eye's witness. The Watch does not blink.

WHEN: Battle-shock step of your Command phase.

TARGET: One friendly Ulthwé **Battleline** unit.

EFFECT: Until your next Command phase, the unit automatically passes Battle-shock tests, and attacks made against this unit cannot benefit from positive modifiers to Hit rolls.

Ulthwé Endures 2 CP

Ulthwé Strike Force — Epic Deed Stratagem

For every Black Guardian who falls, another steps from the long file behind — the same robe, the same rifle, the same unwavering watch.

WHEN: End of your opponent's turn, if a friendly Ulthwé **Guardian Defenders** or **Storm Guardians** unit was destroyed earlier this battle round.

TARGET: That destroyed Ulthwé unit.

EFFECT: Set that unit up again, at half Starting Strength (rounding up), with each model having 1 wound remaining. Place it wholly within your deployment zone and not within 9" of any enemy unit. This Stratagem may be used only once per battle.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Homebrew — 3rd Ed lineage (Codex: Eye of Terror, 2003). The 3rd Edition *Eye of Terror Campaign Codex* introduced the "Ulthwé Strike Force" army list with distinct Black Guardian Defender Squads and Black Guardian Storm Squads — differing from standard Guardians only in BS 4 (vs Guardian BS 3) and WS 4 (vs Storm Guardian WS 3) respectively. From 4th Ed onward those distinct profiles were folded back into the canonical Guardians datasheets. Per project miniature-first policy, the Black Guardian identity is fundamentally a fluff variant of the same kits — this Detachment rule re-expresses the +1 BS/+1 WS pip as a free Detachment buff on the canonical Guardian datasheets, eliminating the need for duplicate standalone HB cards. The four Enhancements span Farseer-anchored Witchblade synergy through to a budget-tier black-robos ward. The six Stratagems lean into Farseer psychic synergy, defensive-on-objective play, and the Standing Army's signature resilience against Battle-shock.

Replaces the retired `black_guardian_defenders_v2_card.html` and `black_guardian_storm_squad_v2_card.html` standalone datacards.

DETACHMENT KEYWORDS

Ulthwé Strike Force • Aeldari • Asuryani • Ulthwé